Name: PRANJAL SWARUP BHATNAGAR **Reg. No.:** RA2512703010007
Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 5 : Session – 1 | Our Participation at Different Levels is Our Value

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. 'OUR PARTICIPATION AT DIFFERENT LEVELS IS OUR VALUE': the value of any unit is its participation in the larger order — so my value as a human being is precisely what I contribute at each level I am part of: in the SELF (living with right understanding and right feeling), with the BODY (health and self-regulation), in the FAMILY (feelings of trust, respect, care...), in SOCIETY (just, fearlessness-promoting participation), and in NATURE (right utilisation and protection). Where my participation enriches the larger order, I am valuable; where it exploits, my value is negative. Hence value is not status or wealth but demonstrated participation.
2. Q2. HUMAN VALUES ARE DEFINITE (as per Lecture 23) because they are rooted in what is EXISTENTIALLY FIXED: (a) co-existence is the reality — harmony is inherent, not invented; (b) the natural acceptance of every Self is the same, unchanging with time, place and person; (c) the needs of Self and Body are definite and distinguishable; (d) the feelings in relationship (trust to love) are definite in content and order; (e) the human goal (right understanding, prosperity, fearlessness, co-existence) is definite; (f) therefore conduct flowing from right understanding is definite — what is valuable does not vary with fashion, market or regime. Unlike man-made rules, values derived from reality cannot be otherwise.
3. Q3. VALUE-BASED LIVING -> MUTUAL HAPPINESS AND MUTUAL PROSPERITY at two levels: (1) at the level of BEHAVIOUR with human beings — when I live with trust, respect and care, the other's need of the Self is fulfilled and mine too; relationship gives mutual happiness, not transaction. (2) at the level of WORK with the rest of nature — when I produce and consume with right utilisation, nature is protected and enriched while my body's needs are fulfilled; this gives mutual prosperity (me prosperous, nature flourishing). Value-based living thus converts both behaviour and work from zero-sum extraction into mutual fulfilment.
4. Q4. ONE VALUE I will practise this week: TRUST — specifically, evaluating my family members and classmates on their INTENTION rather than their competence. Practice: whenever irritation arises at someone's failure or mistake, I will pause and recall that their intention, like mine, is naturally acceptable; then respond with guidance instead of blame. I will observe the effect on my state (fearlessness vs suspicion) and on the relationship, and note it at the week's end.